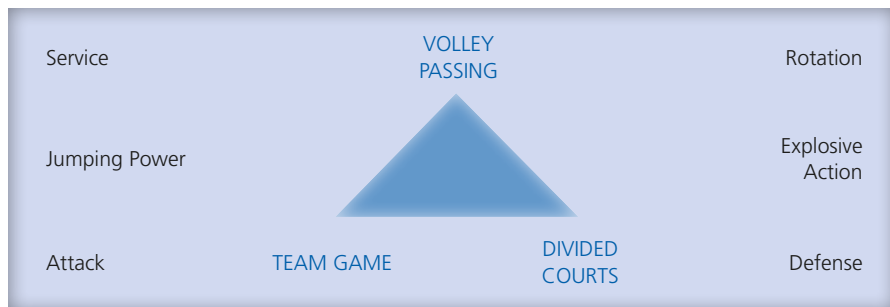


INTRODUCTION

By every measure, Volleyball is one of the world's top sports – it has more affiliated federations, larger TV viewing figures, larger followers at social media, greater numbers of registered and recreational players, than almost any other sport, and an image which is dynamic, clean and colorful, combining highly competitive sport and high-level show.



William Morgan, the game's creator, would still recognize it because Volleyball has retained certain distinctive and essential elements over the years. Some of these it shares with other net/ball/racquet games: – Service – Rotation (taking turns to serve) – Attack – Defense – players able to play at the net and in the back of the court. But the sport has moved on. It is explosive, it is spectacular, it is fast and free flowing, it has athletic players doing sensational things on court in crowded venues.

Additionally, Volleyball is unique amongst net games in insisting that the ball is in constant flight – a flying ball – and by allowing each team a degree of internal passing before the ball must be returned to the opponents, creating a kind sharing of the ball to produce equal opportunities for scoring points.

In recent years the FIVB has made great strides in adapting the game to a modern audience, liberalising the criteria for ball handling, introducing up to two specialist defensive “Libero” players, introducing the technology with the Video Challenge System providing fairness to the effort of the athletes and encouraging policies which promote flowing play to entertain the public, both at venue and on the screen.

THE RULES TEXT

This text is aimed at a broad Volleyball public – players, coaches, referees, spectators, commentators, and others – because an understanding of the rules allows better play and personal satisfaction – coaches can create better team structure and tactics, giving players full rein to display their skills, and an understanding of the relationship between written rules and actual actions on the court allows officials to make better decisions.

Volleyball is both recreational and competitive. Recreational sport taps into the human spirit and promotes “fun” and healthy life. Competition allows people to exhibit the best of ability, creativity, freedom of expression and fighting spirit. The rules are designed and structured to allow all of these facets to flourish.

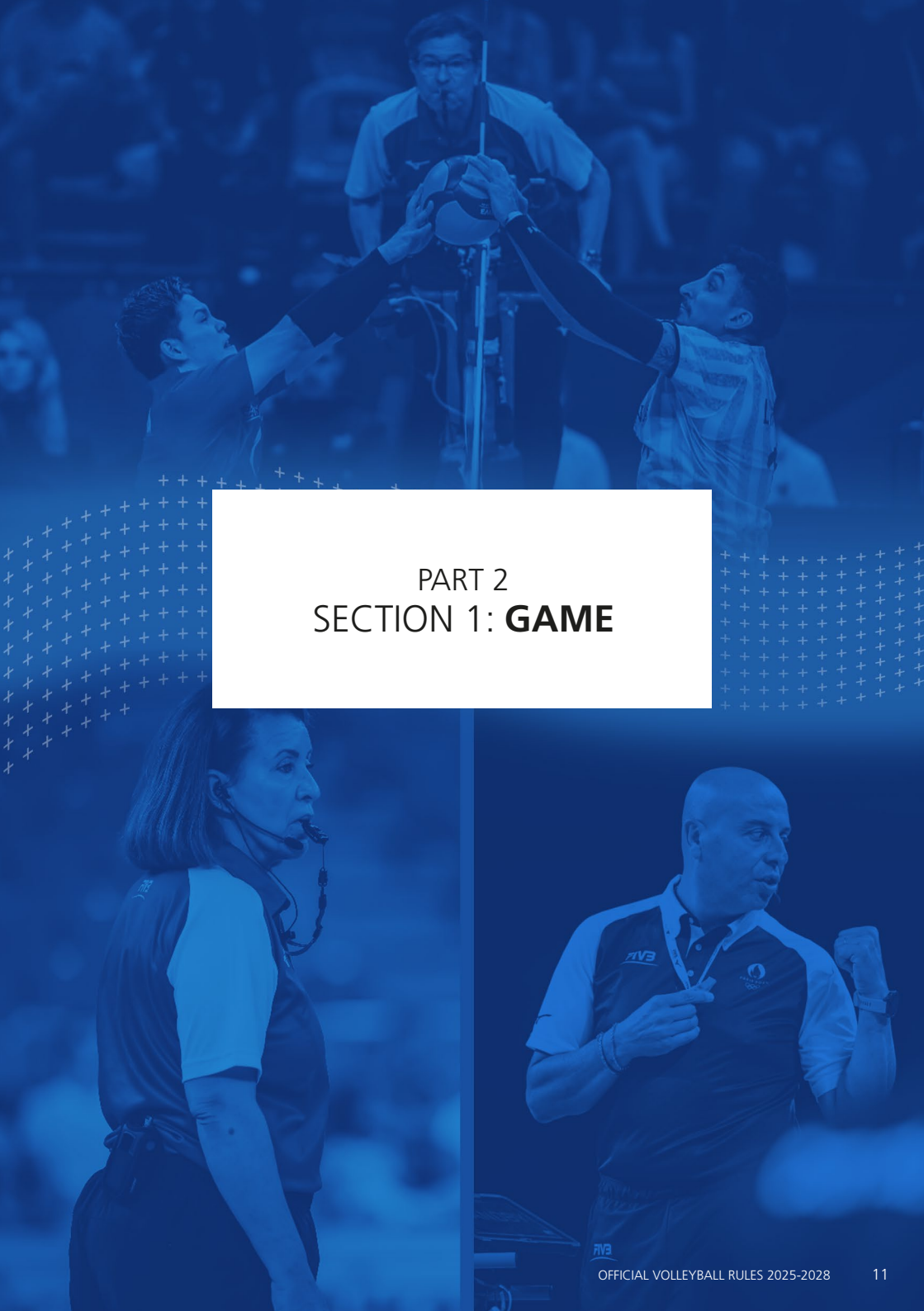
THE REFEREE WITHIN THIS FRAMEWORK

The essence of a good referee lies in the concepts of fairness justice and consistency (being positioned in the middle of both playing courts is a symbol of balance). Together these allow the players to trust the referee's actions. However, the referee must be a facilitator rather than a controller, an orchestra director rather than a dictator, an efficient promoter rather than an "efficient" punisher.

By understanding the reason why a rule has been written and by being clear about its purpose within the framework of the "show", the referee becomes a big part of the overall successful production, while remaining largely in the background and intervening only when necessary. We can say that a good referee will use the rules to make the competition a fulfilling experience for all concerned.

To those who have read thus far, view the rules which follow as the current state of development of a great game, but keep in mind why these preceding few paragraphs may be of equal importance to you in your own position within the sport.

Get involved !
Keep the ball flying !
Understand the game !



PART 2 SECTION 1: **GAME**